

desire, and their size is only restricted by the size of your actual hard drive. It can also mount iso files and zip files in the same manner using this tool though it cannot write to them.

Sound Card Emulator

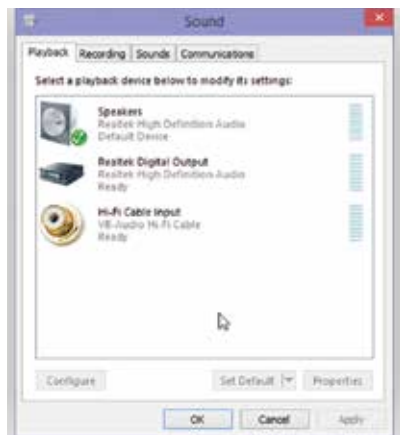
There was a time, long ago when the ability of computers to play sound wasn't a given. It was useful back then — in the absence of the hardware to play sound — to emulate a sound card so that you could still use software that required such a thing. This isn't what these emulators are designed to do though, it is just an anecdotal example of how the author has used such a thing in the past.

In the present day however, the use for such emulators is more specialised. One possible use is to output the audio being played by the computer into a file rather than outputting it to speakers. This could potentially be used to record streaming audio such as Skype conversations, or internet radio.

This is similar is use case to a loopback cable. A loopback cable is basically a physical wire that you can plug into the speaker output, and the microphone input, so you can record whatever is playing using traditional software. Loopback cables cannot record surround sound, or even stereo sound though, so Virtual loopback cable software are incredibly useful. These software emulate a sound card, the output of which is available for recording in a virtual “microphone”. They emulate high end equipment that can let you record multi-track audio among other things.

Another use is to route the audio output of the system to the network, so it can be streamed to be played back on another computers, or to broadcast it so anyone can listen to it.

Virtual Sound Card is a commercial software by e2eSoft that offers many of the features we have highlighted above, such as the ability to record whatever is playing on your computer and the ability to broadcast whatever sound is playing to other computers.



VB-Cable at work.